

Act One, Scene Two

Synopsis

Conflicts begin to build as Troy grumbles about the lottery, lottery winners, Cory's continued involvement in football, and his seeming inability to find the time to build a fence around the yard. Complications in Troy's character are embodied in the arrival of Gabriel, Troy's delusional brother who was injured in World War II.

Vocabulary and References

Archangel Gabriel – angel responsible for sounding the trumpet that will open the gate of Heaven

Numbers – slang for lottery numbers

St. Peter – biblical keeper of Heaven's gate and the Book of Life

1. As the scene opens, Rose sings a hymn. What do fences symbolize for Rose?

2. How does Rose sing to herself? How does this reveal her character?

3. Rose states, "...those that need the least always get lucky. Poor folks can't get nothing." Why, then, does Rose play the lottery?
